

May 14, 2026

DAILY BRIEF

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Ground News Cross-Spectrum Analysis
Portfolio Holdings & Market Intelligence

Daily Brief - Ground News Cross-Spectrum Analysis

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Market Overview

Market Status: S&P 500 and Nasdaq futures rising, Dow reclaimed 50,000

CPI Inflation: 3.8% annually (highest since May 2023)

Bitcoin ETFs: \$630M outflow - largest since January

Key themes: AI infrastructure boom continues, energy prices elevated due to Iran conflict, Fed policy uncertainty persists.

Major Story: CPI Inflation Surges to 3.8%

Bias Spectrum

Left (CNN) - Center (Reuters/BLS) - Right (Fox/WSJ)

Where They Agree (Convergent Facts)

- * CPI rose 3.8% year-over-year in April 2026 (up from 3.3% in March)
- * Monthly increase: 0.6% (seasonally adjusted)
- * Core CPI (excluding food and energy): 2.8% annually
- * Energy costs drove increase due to Iran conflict
- * Highest inflation rate since May 2023

Where They Differ

LEFT SOURCES: Focus on eroding paychecks, cost-of-living pressures, wage stagnation.

CENTER SOURCES: Fact-based reporting on components, technical analysis, Fed policy presented neutrally.

RIGHT SOURCES: Emphasis on negative real rates, criticism of sustained inflation.

Likely Reality

The 3.8% CPI reading is genuinely concerning and driven primarily by energy costs from geopolitical conflict. The Fed faces a dilemma: inflation is above target, but hiking rates further risks recession.

Implication: NEUTRAL-BEARISH - Rate cut expectations pushed back

Portfolio News Analysis

INTC - Intel Corp

Current Price: \$113.61 | Daily: -\$6.68 (-5.55%)

Intel experiencing significant volatility. Faces ongoing challenges in semiconductor landscape against NVIDIA and AMD dominance in AI chips.

Left sources focus on turnaround struggles. Center sources report on earnings. Right sources emphasize competition from AMD/NVIDIA.

Implication: BEARISH short-term

BE - Bloom Energy

Current Price: \$284.03 | Daily: -\$5.73 (-1.98%)

Bloom Energy has been a standout performer with stock surging over 1,500% from lows. Recent developments:

- * Record Q1 2026 results reported
- * Full-year revenue outlook raised
- * Major Oracle fuel cell deal for AI data centers secured
- * Benefits from AI power demand narrative

Left sources highlight environmental angle. Center sources focus on business fundamentals. Right sources emphasize market opportunity.

Implication: BULLISH - AI infrastructure tailwinds

FBTC - Fidelity Bitcoin Fund

Current Price: \$69.57 | Daily: +\$0.27 (+0.38%)

Bitcoin/Crypto Sector Summary:

- * Bitcoin ETFs saw \$630M outflows yesterday (largest since January)
- * Bitcoin price around \$80,000, facing headwinds
- * Senate Banking Committee considering crypto legislation
- * CME Group launching Nasdaq crypto index futures

ETF outflows indicate institutional profit-taking. \$80K level proving to be resistance. Macro environment pressuring crypto.

Implication: NEUTRAL - Choppy conditions

Crypto Mining Holdings

HUT, RIOT, CORZ, CLSK, CIFS - Sector pivoting to AI infrastructure

Key Developments:

- * Hut 8 (HUT): \$9.8B, 15-year AI data center lease; stock surged 35%
- * CleanSpark (CLSK): Doubled MW under contract YoY
- * Core Scientific (CORZ): AMD exercise of option for additional 25 MW
- * Riot Platforms (RIOT): Q1 revenue \$167.2M, data center revenue \$33.2M

AI data center demand driving infrastructure valuations. Hut 8 deal is transformational.

Implication: BULLISH - AI narrative tailwinds

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Energy Holdings

VDE (Vanguard Energy ETF): \$163.86 | +\$0.25 (+0.15%)

XOP (Oil & Gas Exploration): \$167.96 | -\$0.38 (-0.23%)

Sector Summary: Energy prices elevated due to Iran conflict. XOP outperformed VDE over past 3 months (+27.66% vs +15.45%).

Implication: BULLISH - Geopolitical tailwinds

Tech Holdings Summary

- * NVIDIA (NVDA): \$231.48 | +5.65% - Rebounding on AI optimism
- * Micron (MU): \$786.66 | -2.12% - Memory sector pressure
- * Tesla (TSLA): \$444.05 | -0.27% - EV demand questions
- * Alphabet (GOOGL): \$398.55 | -1.02% - Search/AI competition
- * Amazon (AMZN): \$269.83 | -0.04% - Stable, cloud growth

Implication: MIXED - NVDA leading, others mixed

Blindspot Report

Stories Underreported by One Side:

- * Fed Real Rate Calculation: Right sources highlight negative real rates; left sources rarely mention
- * Crypto Miner AI Pivot: Center sources covering extensively; left sources focus on environmental concerns
- * Energy Transition Pace: Left pushing transition; center/right emphasizing energy security
- * Intel Foundry Strategy: Limited cross-spectrum coverage vs TSMC dominance

Pre-Market Outlook

Overall Sentiment: CAUTIOUSLY BULLISH with INFLATION HEADWINDS

Key Factors

POSITIVE: AI infrastructure boom, Tech rebound, Energy sector strength

NEGATIVE: Elevated inflation (3.8%), Fed policy uncertainty, Bitcoin ETF outflows

Portfolio Positioning Notes

- * Bloom Energy (BE) has become top performer - consider trimming
- * Crypto miners benefitting from AI pivot - monitor Bitcoin correlation
- * Intel (INTC) showing weakness - reassess thesis
- * Energy holdings (VDE, XOP) well-positioned for inflation
- * Bitcoin exposure via FBTC facing near-term headwinds

Risk Management

- * Inflation could force Fed to hold rates higher for longer
- * Geopolitical risks (Iran) could spike energy prices
- * AI bubble concerns could pressure high-flyers

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